



TB AUDIO PLUG-INS
Team Impulse Impact

USER MANUAL

TB Tape

Tape Stop and Start

A tape-style varispeed motor: press PAUSE and the sound slows down and drops in pitch to a stop, press PLAY and it spins back up, along a curve you can draw.

Stop and start 0 to 2 s

6 curve shapes + drawing

Automatable PLAY

8 factory presets



Contents

- 01 Overview
- 02 Quick start
- 03 Interface
- 04 Controls
- 05 Presets
- 06 Recipes
- 07 Tips and troubleshooting
- 08 Parameter reference
- 09 Version history
- 10 Support and license

01 Overview

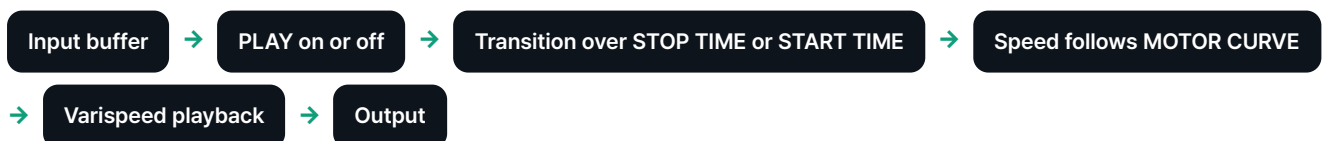
TB Tape recreates the sound of a tape machine whose motor is switched off and on. When you pause it, speed and pitch fall together until the tape stops; when you play it again, the tape spins back up to normal speed.

STOP TIME and **START TIME** set how long each transition takes, from instant to two seconds. **MOTOR CURVE** sets how the speed changes along the way, from a straight line to slow, sudden, or stepped changes, or a curve you draw yourself. Because **PLAY** is a host parameter, you can automate tape stops at exact positions in your song.

Key features

- Varispeed tape stop and spin-up: speed and pitch change together
- Independent STOP TIME and START TIME, each from 0 to 2 seconds
- MOTOR CURVE with six shapes, freehand drawing, and editable points
- Automatable PLAY parameter for exact stops and starts
- Reels that show the tape motion live
- Bypass that stays aligned with the plug-in's processing latency
- 8 factory presets, user presets, undo, and redo

Signal flow



About this manual

This manual describes TB Tape 1.0.0 for Windows (VST3). The current macOS build (AU and VST3) is also version 1.0.0; small differences between platforms are possible.

02 Quick start

- 1 Insert TB Tape on a track, bus, or the master. The defaults are **STOP TIME** 200 ms, **START TIME** 200 ms, and a LINEAR curve.

- 2 Start playback and click **PLAY** / **PAUSE** 9. The tape slows to a stop over STOP TIME; click again and it spins back up over START TIME.
- 3 Set **STOP TIME** 4 and **START TIME** 5 for shorter or longer transitions.
- 4 Choose a shape from the curve shape box 7, or draw your own curve 6.
- 5 To place stops exactly, automate the Play parameter in your host.

03 Interface



TB Tape 1.0 interface with the default settings.

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> 1 Reels — show the tape motion live. 2 BYPASS — bypasses the complete tape-stop effect. 3 TB TAPE menu — click the title for factory and user presets, Save, Undo, and Redo. 4 STOP TIME (BRAKE) — how long the tape takes to stop. 5 START TIME (SPIN-UP) — how long the tape takes to return to speed. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> 6 MOTOR CURVE — the speed curve used for the transitions. 7 Curve shape box — LINEAR, S-CURVE, SLOW IN, FAST IN, STEPPED, or MOTOR DRAG; shows CUSTOM after you edit the curve. 8 DRAW / POINTS — the two ways to edit the curve. 9 PLAY / PAUSE — plays or pauses the tape motor. |
|---|---|

04 Controls

Control	Range · default	What it does
PLAY / PAUSE	Play, Pause · Play	Plays or pauses the tape motor. Pausing slows the tape to a stop over STOP TIME; playing spins it back up over START TIME. Automate the Play parameter to trigger stops at exact song positions.
STOP TIME	0 to 2000 ms · 200 ms	How long the tape takes to stop (BRAKE). At 0 ms it stops instantly. The knob has an exponential scale, so short times are easier to set.

Control	Range · default	What it does
START TIME	0 to 2000 ms · 200 ms	How long the tape takes to spin back up to normal speed (SPIN-UP).
BYPASS	Off, On · Off	Bypasses the complete tape-stop effect. TB Tape reports its processing latency to the host, and the bypassed signal stays aligned with it.

Motor curve

The curve shows how far the speed change has progressed (bottom to top) during a transition (left to right). Its shape decides whether the speed changes evenly, early, late, or in steps.

Shape or mode	What it does
LINEAR	An even change from start to finish.
S-CURVE , SLOW IN , FAST IN , STEPPED , MOTOR DRAG	Ready-made shapes; choose them from the curve shape box and compare by ear.
DRAW	Drag across the graph to sketch a curve.
POINTS	Drag nodes to move them. Double-click empty space to add a node, or double-click a node to delete it.
CUSTOM	Shown in the shape box after you edit the curve.

The curve is not a host parameter. It is saved with the plug-in state and in presets. Curve edits can be undone and redone from the TB TAPE menu.

05 Presets

Click the TB TAPE title to open the preset menu. It lists the factory presets in the STARTING POINTS and FX groups and your user presets, and offers PREVIOUS PRESET, NEXT PRESET, SAVE USER PRESET..., UNDO, and REDO. Saved presets use the .tbtape extension and include the curve. In the table, a curve exponent of 1.0 is linear; lower values change the speed early, higher values late.

Group	Preset	STOP TIME	START TIME	Curve (exponent)
STARTING POINTS	Init	200 ms	200 ms	Linear (1.0)
STARTING POINTS	Quick Brake	80 ms	120 ms	Linear (1.0)
STARTING POINTS	Soft Brake	600 ms	350 ms	Early change (0.5)
STARTING POINTS	Slow Spin-Up	180 ms	1000 ms	Linear (1.0)
FX	Instant Motor	0 ms	0 ms	Linear (1.0)
FX	Long Coast	2000 ms	450 ms	Linear (1.0)
FX	Late Drop	1000 ms	350 ms	Late change (4.0)
FX	Early Brake	1000 ms	800 ms	Early change (0.25)

06 Recipes

Starting points for common jobs. Adjust them by ear.

Classic tape stop

The whole mix winds down at the end of a section.

Preset Init or Soft Brake

STOP TIME 400 to 800 ms

- 1 Automate Play to switch off on the last beat before the drop, and on again at the downbeat.

Quick brake

A short, sharp stop on drums or a vocal phrase.

Preset Quick Brake

STOP TIME 50 to 120 ms

- 1 Use it on one track or bus so the rest of the mix keeps playing.

Slow spin-up

A record-like start that rises into pitch.

Preset Slow Spin-Up

START TIME 800 to 1500 ms

- 1 Switch Play on slightly before the downbeat so the music is up to speed in time.

Late drop

Speed that holds, then falls away at the end.

Preset Late Drop

STOP TIME around 1000 ms

- 1 Edit the curve in POINTS mode to move where the drop begins.

07 Tips and troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Nothing happens when I press PAUSE.	BYPASS is on, or the host is not playing audio through the track.
The stop is too abrupt.	Raise STOP TIME, or choose a curve that changes early, such as Early Brake.
The music comes back late.	Shorten START TIME, or switch Play on earlier.
The curve shows CUSTOM.	The curve was edited. Choose a shape from the shape box to replace it.
I cannot automate the curve.	The curve is not a host parameter. Save different curves as presets, or automate Play, STOP TIME, and START TIME.

08 Parameter reference

Panel label	Host parameter	Range	Default
PLAY / PAUSE	Play	Play, Pause	Play
STOP TIME	Stop Time	0 to 2000 ms	200 ms
START TIME	Start Time	0 to 2000 ms	200 ms
BYPASS	Bypass	Off, On	Off

09 Version history

Version	Changes
1.0.0 · 2026-08-10	First release: a tape-style varispeed motor with independent 0 to 2 second stop and start times; freehand and point-based motor curves with six curve shortcuts; eight factory presets; latency-aligned bypass; a compact 498 × 260 reel-deck interface with live tape-motion feedback.

10 Support and license

Report problems or request features at github.com/TaebeumKim/TB_Audio-Plugins/issues. Include the plug-in version, your DAW, and your operating system.

TB Audio plug-ins are free for personal and commercial work under the TB Audio Plug-ins Freeware License. If you release or monetize work made with them, add a credit such as **Made with TB Audio Plug-ins by Team Impulse Impact**. Selling or bundling the plug-ins is not allowed.

If the plug-ins help your music, you can support development at ko-fi.com/teamimpulseimpact.